

Unified Study Definitions Model

All Your Questions Answered 😊

12th June 2025

Dave Iberson-Hurst

Disclosure

- I am currently working on contract to CDISC as the CDISC USDM Product Owner
- The views expressed during this presentation are my own and **NOT** those of CDISC
- You will see many CDISC slides. They were all created by myself, except for the 360i slide. All have been presented at various public events.
- There is a Transcelerate slide within the presentation. This has been presented within public forums.

Questions

The background is a dark blue gradient with various geometric shapes and lines. There are several yellow circles of different sizes, some connected by thin yellow lines. There are also some grey cubes and a cluster of small grey dots on the left side. A bright yellow circular glow is at the bottom right, with lines radiating from it.

Questions People Ask

- What is it?
- ICH M11?
- How do the pieces fit together?
- BCs Downstream ...?
- Benefits?
- What's Next?



The background is a dark blue gradient with various geometric shapes and lines. On the left, there is a network of small circles connected by thin lines. In the center and right, there are larger, glowing yellow circles and lines, some of which are connected to a bright yellow circular glow at the bottom right. There are also several small, semi-transparent cubes scattered throughout the scene.

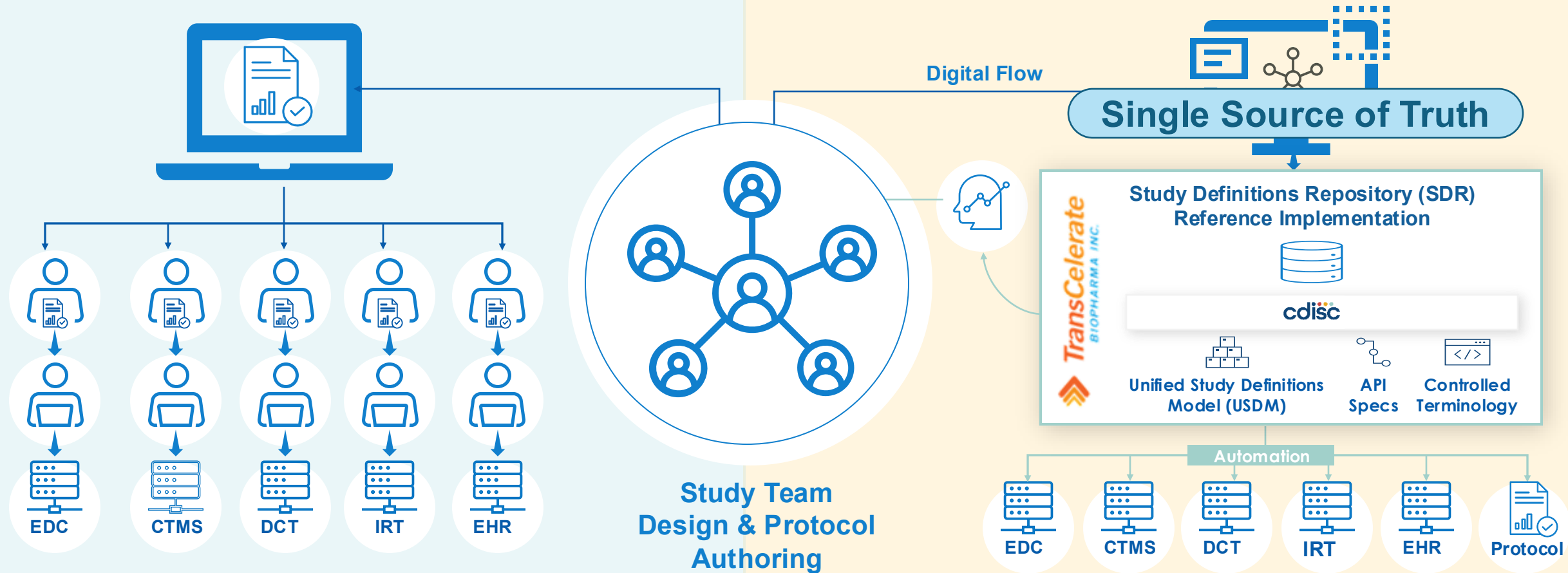
What is it?

TransCelerate Digital Data Flow (DDF) Ambition

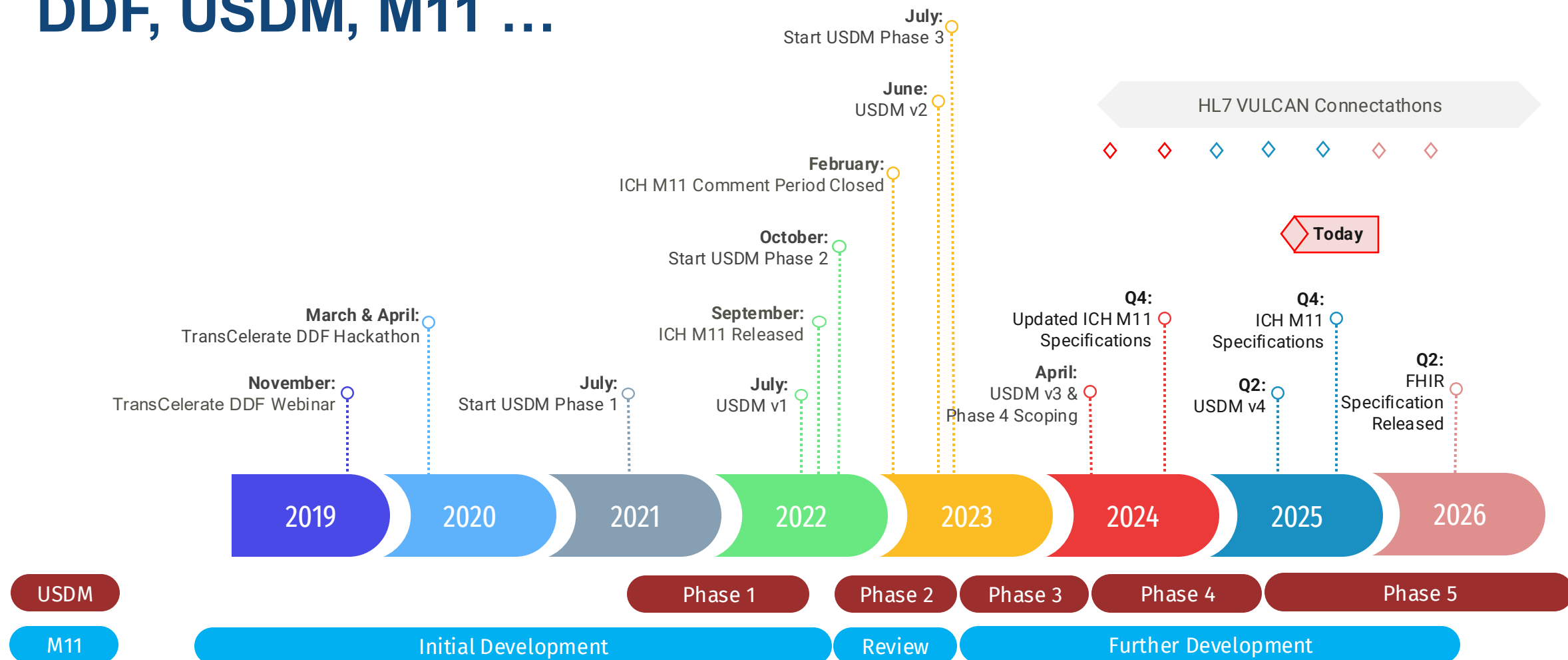
Write Once, Read Many

TODAY: Document-based paradigm for protocol creation, interpretation, and transcription into consuming systems

TOMORROW: Digital paradigm for protocol creation, with fully automated data flow and interoperability between systems



DDF, USDM, M11 ...



June 2018

Acronyms

DDF: Digital Data Flow

USDM: Unified Study Definitions Model

ICH: International Council for Harmonisation

M11: Clinical electronic Structured Harmonised Protocol (CeSHarP)

The USDM Standard

CDISC Controlled Terminology

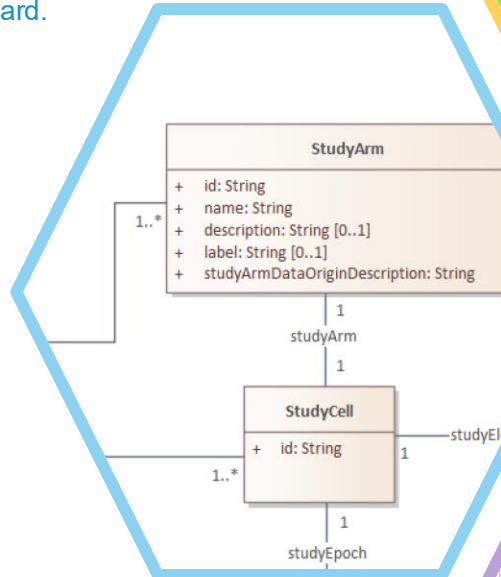
Provides further semantics, complementing the UML model.
Includes the definition of classes, attributes, and value sets

Examples

Example protocols implemented in the USDM
with associated JSON files and visualisations

Logical Model

The UML logical model (a class diagram) that provides the basis for the USDM standard.



API Specification

Provides the means to exchange a single study between machines using a JSON API

	C174447	Study Arm
	C170984	Study Arm Name
	C93728	Study Arm Description
	C188827	Study Arm Type
Study Arm Data Origin Description	C188828	Study Arm Data Origin Description
Study Arm Data Origin Type	C188829	Study Arm Data Origin Type
Study Arm Label	CNEW	Study Arm Label
Study Epoch	C71738	Study Epoch
Study Epoch Name	C93825	Study Epoch Name
Study Epoch Description	C93824	Study Epoch Description
Study Epoch Type	C188830	Study Epoch Type
Study Epoch Label	CNEW	Study Epoch Label

CORE Rules

Specification of the rules that define USDM compliance

A	B	Warning/ Error	Entity/ applies
Rule			
must conform with the USDM schema based on the			
Attributes (string, number, boolean) must conform with schema based on the API specification.		ERROR	All
must be included as defined in the USDM schema based on specification (i.e., all required properties are present and no		ERROR	All
Qualities must be as defined in the USDM schema based on the API specification (i.e., required properties have at least one value and single		ERROR	All

Version 4 Now Released

POST	/v3/studyDefinitions	Create a study
PUT	/v3/studyDefinitions/{studyId}	Update a study
GET	/v3/studyDefinitions/{studyId}	Return a study
GET	/v3/studyDefinitions/{studyId}/history	Returns the study history
GET	/v3/studyDesigns	Study designs for a study

Implementation Guide

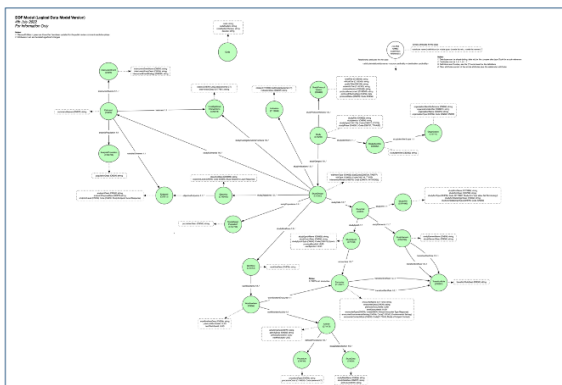
Guidance on using the USDM model and ensuring conformance with the standard

```
studyArms": [
  {
    "id": "StudyArm_1",
    "name": "Placebo",
    "label": "",
    "description": "Placebo",
    "type": {
      "id": "Code_61",
      "code": "C174268",
      "codeSystem": "http://www.cdisc.org",
      "codeSystemVersion": "2022-12-16",
      "decode": "Placebo Comparator Arm"
    }
  },
  {
    "id": "StudyArm_2",
    "name": "Xanomeline Low Dose",
    "label": "",
    "description": "Active Substance",
    "type": {
      "id": "Code_63",
      "code": "C174267",
      "codeSystem": "http://www.cdisc.org",
      "codeSystemVersion": "2022-12-16",
      "decode": "Active Comparator Arm"
    }
  }
]
```

on 2.0 Draft for Internal Review)		
Unified Study Definitions Model Implementation Guide (USDM-IG)		
Version 2.0 (Draft for Internal Review)		
Prepared by the DDF Team		
Notes to Readers		
This is the draft version 2.0 of the Unified Study Definitions Model Implementation Guide (USDM-IG v2.0). It is intended for Internal Review only and is not a final version.		
History		
<table><tr><th>Version</th></tr><tr><td>2.0 Draft for Internal Review</td></tr></table>	Version	2.0 Draft for Internal Review
Version		
2.0 Draft for Internal Review		
data Interchange Standards Consortium, Inc. All rights reserved.		

CDISC DDF / USDM, Phases One to Four

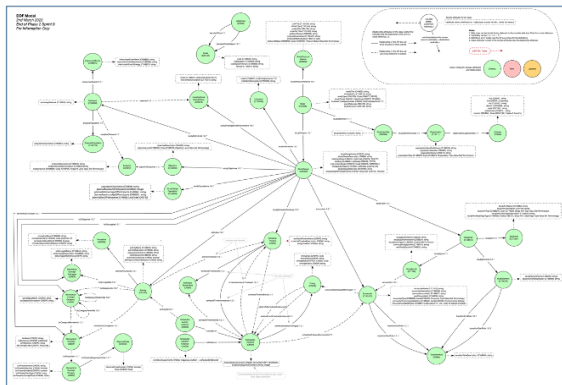
Phase One



25 Classes

- Solid foundation
- The protocol document was an external entity into which the structured content could be exported

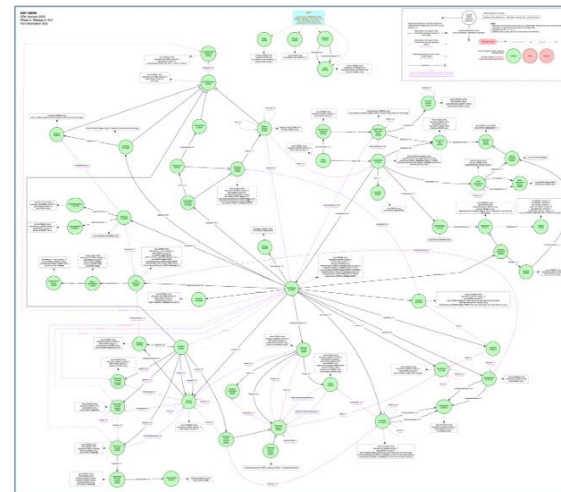
Phase Two



35 Classes

- Focused on the structured elements of the protocol, e.g. the Schedule of Activities (SoA) & Biomedical Concepts (BCs)
- The protocol document still an external entity

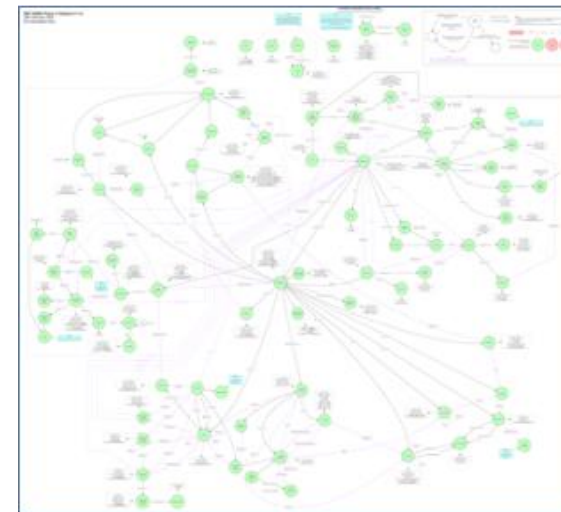
Phase Three



58 Classes

- Now contains structured and unstructured elements
- The entire protocol document can be held within the USDM
- Allows for the protocol document to be generated from the model

Phase Four



89 Classes

- Aligned with ICH M11
- Support for complex studies, interventional & observational studies, and medical devices
- Maximise content re-use and support for multiple document templates
- Extension mechanism to provide flexibility

DDF Web Page

<https://www.cdisc.org/ddf>



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Digital Data Flow

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Welcome to Digital Data Flow (DDF) for Clinical Trial Protocols

Digital Data Flow Initiative will help modernize clinical trials by enabling a digital workflow with protocol digitization. This initiative establishes a foundation for a future state of automated & dynamic readiness that can transform the drug development process.

Below are a list of the different websites sourcing specific content and resources. Depending on where you are in the journey, please feel free to explore the different websites and their information.



CDISC DDF Website

You are here!

Learn about and access the Unified Study Definitions Model (USDM) Reference Architecture supporting Digital Protocol Data



DDF Website

As the main website for the DDF initiative, learn and access all resources for DDF solutions



DDF GitHub Repos

Learn about a technical Reference Implementation of the USDM, the Study Definitions Repository (SDR), and access the



**TransCelerate
DDF Initiative Solutions**

Learn about DDF Initiative background and roadmap

CDISC DDF



Scan Me



DDF-RA (USDM) GitHub

<https://github.com/cdisc-org/DDF-RA>

The screenshot displays the GitHub repository for **DDF-RA** (Public), generated from [cdisc-org/COSAHackathonTemplate](#). The repository has 49 issues, 1 pull request, 11 forks, and 16 stars. The file structure includes:

- .github/workflows**: use gh output instead of deprecated set-output (6 months ago)
- Deliverables**: Generate Diff and Data Dict (2 weeks ago) - *highlighted with a red circle and an arrow pointing to the detailed view*
- Documents**: Update informative diagram for criteria tweak (3 weeks ago)
- HowTos**: Initial commit
- images**: Initial commit
- .gitignore**: Updated Objective and Endpoint
- CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md**: Updated the enforcement contact
- CONTRIBUTING.md**: Initial commit
- LICENSE**: Update copyright holder
- README.md**: Update README.md

The **About** section states: "This is the repository for all code and documentation for the DDF-RA project." It includes links to the Readme, MIT license, Code of conduct, Activity, and Custom properties.

The detailed view of the **Deliverables** directory shows a list of files and their last commit messages:

Name	Last commit message
..	
API	API updates
CT	Update USDM_CT.xlsx
IG	Added USDMIG post copy editing
RULES	Set of USDM v3.0 rules
UML	Pushed to wrong branch, reverting

CDISC GitHub



Scan Me

The background is a dark blue gradient with various abstract geometric elements. On the left, there is a cluster of small circles connected by thin lines, with a larger circle in the center. To the right, there are several larger circles, some of which are connected by lines to a bright yellow circular area at the bottom right. There are also several 3D cubes scattered throughout the scene, some of which are connected by lines to the yellow area. The overall aesthetic is technical and futuristic.

ICH M11?

M11 Is ...

ICH CLINICAL ELECTRONIC STRUCTURED HARMONISED PROTOCOL (CeSHarP)

<https://www.ich.org/page/multidisciplinary-guidelines>



INTERNATIONAL COUNCIL FOR HARMONISATION OF TECHNICAL
REQUIREMENTS FOR PHARMACEUTICALS FOR HUMAN USE

ICH HARMONISED GUIDELINE

CLINICAL ELECTRONIC STRUCTURED HARMONISED PROTOCOL (CeSHarP)

M11

Draft version

Endorsed on 27 September 2022

Currently under public consultation

At Step 2 of the ICH Process, a consensus draft text or guideline, agreed by the appropriate ICH Expert Working Group, is transmitted by the ICH Assembly to the regulatory authorities of the ICH regions for internal and external consultation, according to national or regional procedures.

Provides background, purpose, and
scope as a guideline



INTERNATIONAL COUNCIL FOR HARMONISATION OF TECHNICAL
REQUIREMENTS FOR PHARMACEUTICALS FOR HUMAN USE

ICH HARMONISED GUIDELINE

CLINICAL ELECTRONIC STRUCTURED HARMONISED PROTOCOL (CeSHarP)

M11 TEMPLATE

Draft version

Endorsed on 27 September 2022

Currently under public consultation

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Provides the written format for the
Interventional Clinical Trial Protocol
Template



INTERNATIONAL COUNCIL FOR HARMONISATION OF TECHNICAL
REQUIREMENTS FOR PHARMACEUTICALS FOR HUMAN USE

ICH HARMONISED GUIDELINE

CLINICAL ELECTRONIC STRUCTURED HARMONISED PROTOCOL (CeSHarP)

M11 TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

Draft version

Endorsed on 27 September 2022

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Provides the technical representation
aligned with the guideline and protocol
template

M11 & USDM

The graphic shows the links between the Trial Phase field that is defined as part of the M11 Title Page to the M11 Technical Specification, on to the USDM and onwards to an implementation of USDM and M11

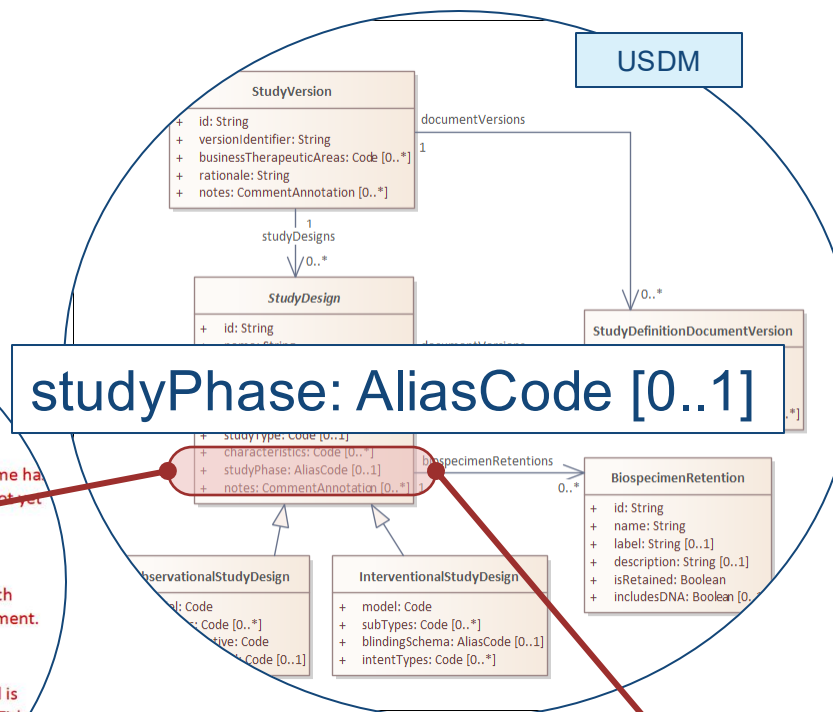
- A StudyDesign has a studyPhase
- studyPhase is an AliasCode
- AliasCode can store:
 - a single standard code (CDISC Trial Phase Response, C66737) using the Code class
 - And zero or more other alias codes (e.g. a sponsor phase code) using the Code class to provide flexibility

[Trial Phase]

Trial Phase: For trials combining investigational drugs or vaccines with devices, classify according to the phase of drug development.

Short Title: Short title should convey in plain language what the trial is about and should be suitable for use as "Brief Title" or "Title Plain Language" in global clinical trial registries. It can also be suitable for use with informed consents and ethics committee submissions.

Template Specification



Phase 1 (C15600)	Valid Value
	C48281
	For review purpose, see definition of the controlled terminology below
	A stage in the clinical research and development of a therapy from first-in-human to post-approval clinical trials.
User Guidance	For trials combining investigational drugs or vaccines with devices, classify according to the phase of drug development
Conformance	
Cardinality	
Relationship content from ToC representing the protocol hierarchy	
Value	Early Phase 1 (C54721); Phase 1(C15600); Phase 1/Phase 2 (C15693) Phase 1/Phase 2/Phase 3 (C198366); Phase 1/Phase 3(C198367); Phase 2(C15601); Phase 2/Phase 3(C15694); Phase2/Phase 3/Phase 4(CNEW); Phase 3(C15602) Phase 3/Phase 4 (CNEW); Phase 4 (C15603)))
rules	Value Allowed: Yes
	Relationship: Heading; Sponsor Protocol Identifier
	Concept: C48281
	No

Technical Specification

Trial Phase:	Phase I
Short Title:	RadVax™: Pembrolizumab & Hypofractionated Radiotherapy
Sponsor Name and Address:	University of Pennsylvania
	Address on File.
Primary Agency Identifier	UPCC# 40914
	IRB# 821402

Implementation

ICH and CDISC MOU (Memorandum of Understanding)

As a collaboration between ICH and CDISC, the goals of the agreement are to:

- Use a unified governance process and terminology services for the long-term support of ICH controlled terminologies
- Curate and maintain ICH controlled terminologies
- Follow a robust process for the public review and publication of ICH terminologies
- Ensure the terminologies are freely available to the public following public review

Scope

For ICH members to adopt and implement a clinical information standard it is critical that all terminology components, including but not limited to definitions described in the technical specification, are part of a greater international controlled terminology resource managed by an internationally recognized standards development organization (SDO). CDISC has been identified by ICH as a reputable SDO with the qualifications and capabilities to support the maintenance and facilitation of the governance process for ICH controlled terminology.

This Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) sets forth the roles and responsibilities of each party as they relate to the governance of the ICH terms and definitions developed in collaboration with CDISC. This MOU is intended to describe the goals, the high-level governance process, and how each party will collaborate. Specific projects (e.g., M11 controlled terminology) will be defined in detail as part of an annex to this MOU mutually agreed upon by CDISC and ICH.

Goals

As a collaboration between ICH and CDISC, the goals of the agreement are to:

1. Use a unified governance process and terminology services for the long-term support of ICH controlled terminologies.
2. Curate and maintain ICH controlled terminologies.
3. Follow a robust process for the public review and publication of ICH terminologies
4. Ensure the terminologies are freely available to the public following public review.



The graphic provides a visual guide to how the content defined by the ICH M11 Template specification is handled within USDM

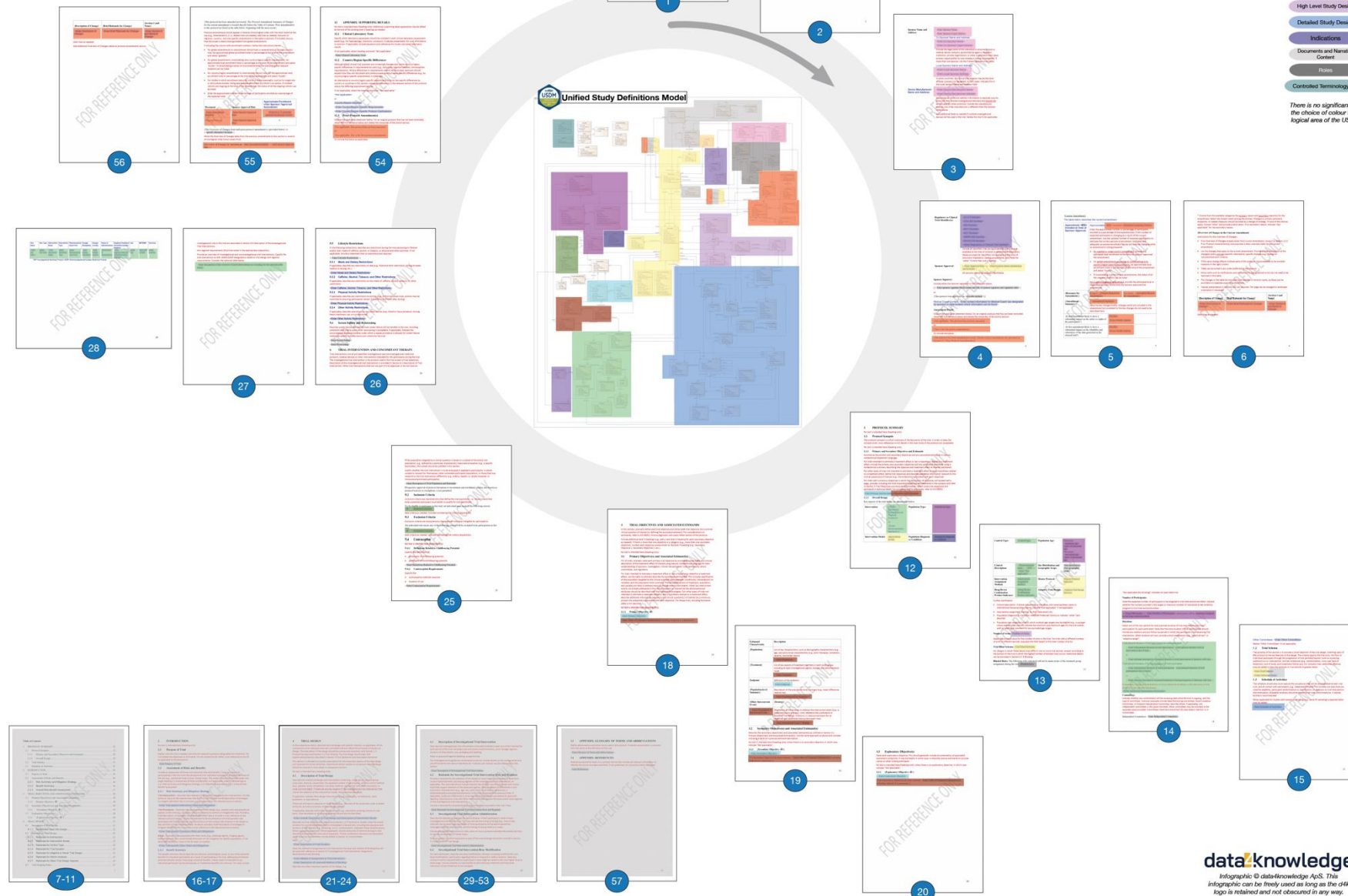
M11 and USDM Alignment

Created by: D. Benson-Hunt, data4knowledge ApS
Version 2, 2025-06-09

Based On
M11: Updated Step 2 Draft (2025-09-18)
USDM: Version 4.0.0 (2025-06-09)

This infographic shows the relationship between the M11 protocol template specification and the structured and annotated capabilities of the USDM. Each logical area of the M11 protocol template is highlighted along with the associated area within the USDM.

The "mapping" is not precise, it is indicative so as to provide an overview of relationship of an M11 protocol document and the USDM. It endeavours to show how the elements of a protocol document can be stored within the model and how the document can be generated from a populated model.



The graphic provides a visual guide to how the



M11 and USDM Alignment
Created by: D Benson-Hunt, dataknowledge ApS
Version 2, 2025-06-09

Based On
M11: Updated Step 2 Draft 2025-09-19
USDM: Version 4.0.0 2025-06-09

The order of the title page elements should be preserved.

Sponsor Confidentiality Statement:

<Enter Sponsor Confidentiality Statement>

Insert the Sponsor's confidentiality statement, if applicable, otherwise delete.

Full Title:

<Enter Full Title>

The protocol should have a descriptive title that identifies the scientific aspects of the trial sufficiently to ensure it is immediately evident what the trial is investigating and on whom, and to allow retrieval from literature or internet searches.

Trial Acronym:

<Enter Trial Acronym>

Acronym or abbreviation used publicly to identify the clinical trial. Delete this line from the table if not applicable.

Sponsor Protocol Identifier:

<Enter Sponsor Protocol Identifier>

A unique alphanumeric identifier for the trial, designated by the Sponsor.

Original Protocol:

[Original Protocol Indicator]

Version Number:

<Enter Version Number>

For use by the Sponsor at their discretion.

Version Date:

<Enter Version Date>

For use by the Sponsor at their discretion.

{Amendment Identifier:}

{[Amendment Identifier]}

Enter the amendment identifier (e.g., amendment number). If this is the original instance of the protocol, delete the row or enter "Not applicable".

1

Scan Me



1

2

3

4

5

6

12

13

14

15

19

20

18



The graphic provides a visual guide to how the content defined by the ICH M11 Template specification is handled within USDM

M11 and USDM Alignment

Created by: D. Benson-Hunt, data4knowledge ApS
Version 2, 2025-06-09

Based On
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Other Committees: <Enter Other Committees>

Delete "Other Committees" if not applicable.

1.2 Trial Schema

The purpose of this section is to provide a visual depiction of the trial design, orienting users of the protocol to the key features of the design. The schema depicts the trial arms, the flow of individual participant through the progression of trial period(s)/epochs (such as screening, washout/run-in, intervention, and key milestones [e.g., randomisation, cross-over, end of treatment, end of study, post-treatment follow-up]). For complex trials, additional schemas may be added to describe activities or trial periods in greater detail.

<Enter Trial Schema>

<Enter Schema Notes>

1.3 Schedule of Activities

The schedule of activities must capture the procedures that will be accomplished at each trial visit, and all contact with participants, e.g., telephone contacts. This includes any tests that are used for eligibility, participant randomisation or stratification, or decisions on trial intervention discontinuation. Allowable windows should be stated for all visits and procedures. A tabular format is recommended.

When applicable for studies with extensive sampling (e.g., serial PK sampling) a separate table may be added.

<Enter Schedule of Activities>

USDM <=> M11



Scan Me



HL7 FHIR Connectathon

Dallas, May 2024



Protocol



Manual Translation
of the original
protocol into the
M11 Template



Protocol in
M11

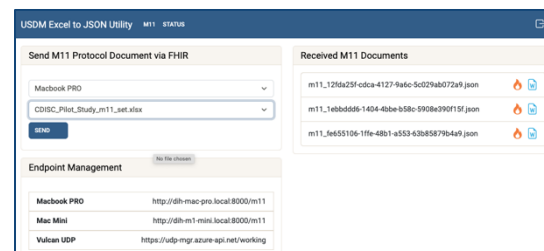


Protocol in
USDM, M11
Template

Manual creation of
the original protocol
into USDM including
SoA. Add in the M11
presentation.



Import



USD M Web-based
Test Utility

FHIR M11 Message / Profile

FHIR Server



VULCAN
HL7 FHIR

FHIR M11 Message / Profile

FEvIR Platform
Computable Publishing



FHIR Viewer



NProgram Ltd



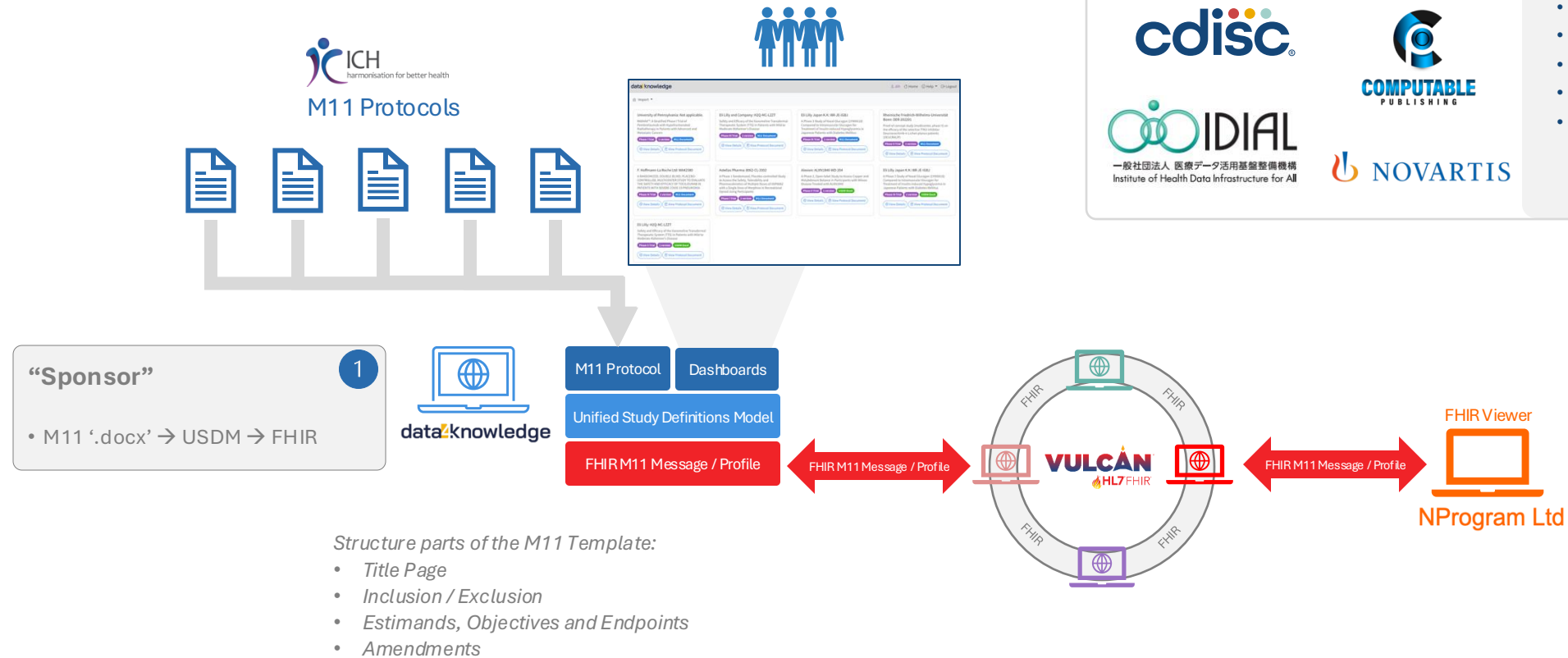
Manual importation
of the protocol into
the FEvIR system



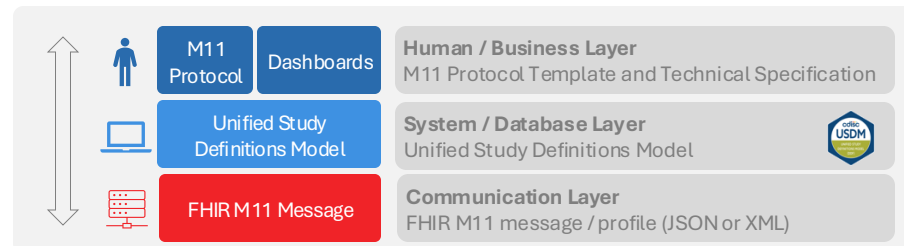
- Brian Alper, Computable Publishing
- Matt Elrod, ONC
- Hugh Glover, Vulcan **TRACK LEAD**
- Dave Iberson-Hurst, CDISC
- Dan Newingham, ZS Associates
- Jimita Parekh, ICH M11/M2
- Khalid Shahin, Computable Publishing
- Rik Smithies, HL7 UK
- Kimberly Tableman, Espero
- Panagiotis Telonis, ICH M11/M2
- Stacy Tegan, Vulcan, TransCelerate
- Rob Ferendo, TransCelerate

HL7 FHIR Connectathon

Atlanta, September 2024



- Brian Alper, Computable Publishing
- Hugh Glover, Vulcan *TRACK LEAD*
- Dave Iberson-Hurst, CDISC
- Khalid Shahin, Computable Publishing
- Rik Smithies, HL7 UK
- Stacy Tegan, Vulcan, TransCelerate
- Rob Ferendo, TransCelerate
- Mary Lynn Mercado, Novartis
- Enam Rahman, TransCelerate
- Mihoko Okada, Idial



HL7 FHIR Connectathon

Virtual, January 2025

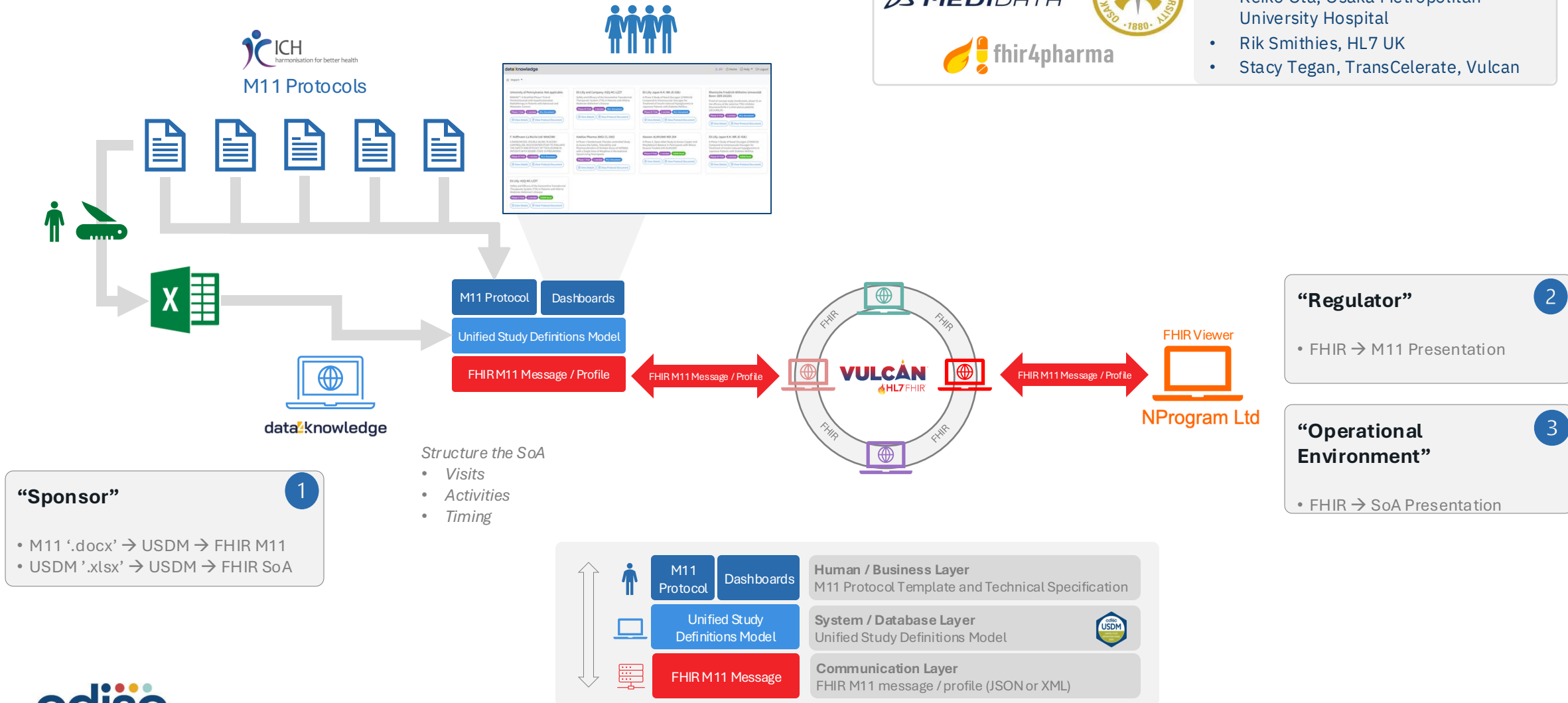






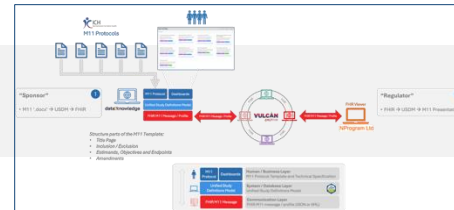


- Hugh Glover, Vulcan TRACK LEAD
- Rob Ferendo, TransCelerate
- Patrick Genyn, fhir4pharma
- Dave Iberson-Hurst, CDISC
- Geoff Low, Medidata
- Keiko Ota, Osaka Metropolitan University Hospital
- Rik Smithies, HL7 UK
- Stacy Tegan, TransCelerate, Vulcan

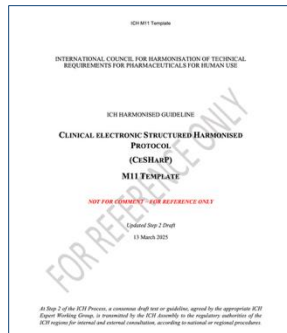


HL7 FHIR Connectathon

Madrid, May 2025



Dallas & Atlanta Connectathons



ICH M11 Template & Technical Specifications

Code	Value	Source	Comments	Notes	Comments
1	1	1	1	1	1
2	2	2	2	2	2
3	3	3	3	3	3
4	4	4	4	4	4
5	5	5	5	5	5
6	6	6	6	6	6
7	7	7	7	7	7
8	8	8	8	8	8
9	9	9	9	9	9
10	10	10	10	10	10

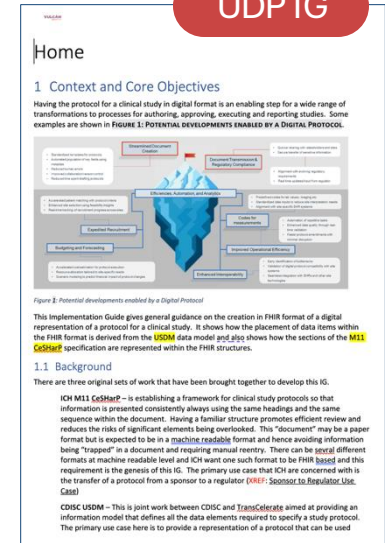
ICH M11 and CDISC USDM share the same CT

Controlled Terms

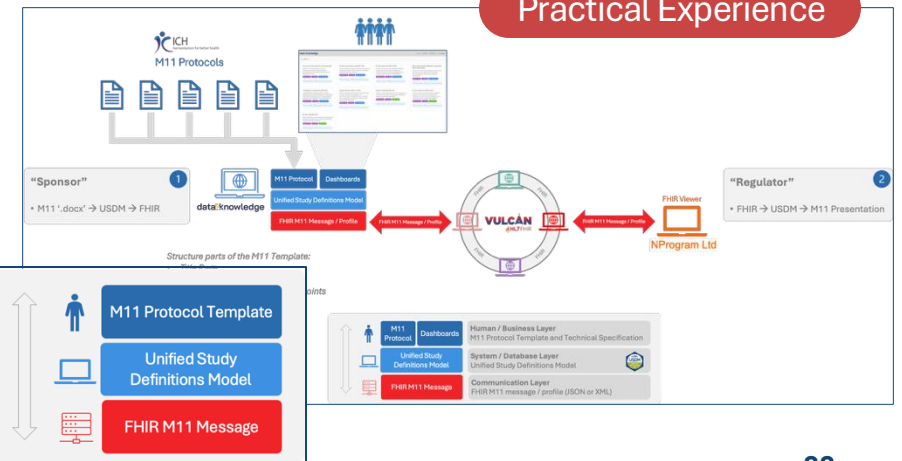


CDISC USDM Logical Model

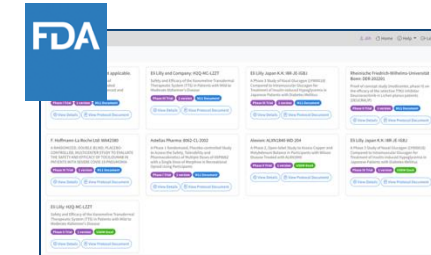
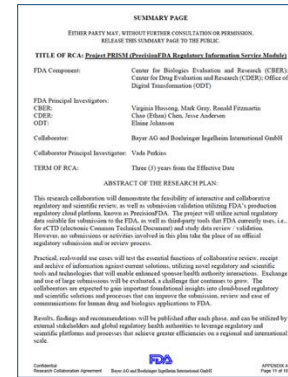
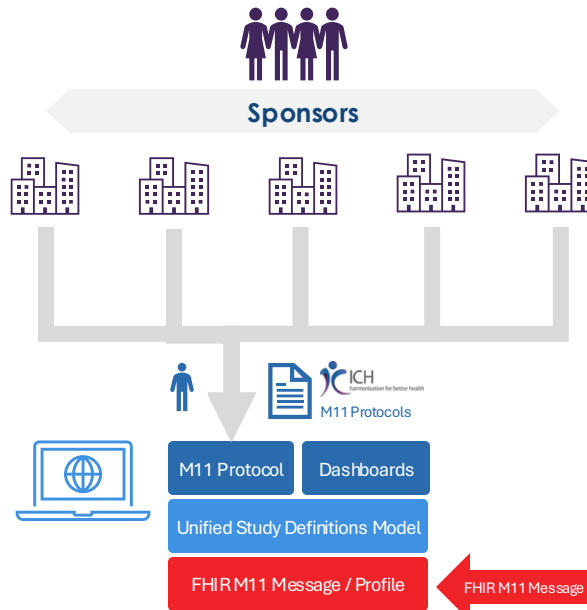
UDP IG



Practical Experience



precisionFDA Regulatory Information Service Module FDA-Industry Research Collaboration Agreement (Public-Private Partnership)



Sponsor

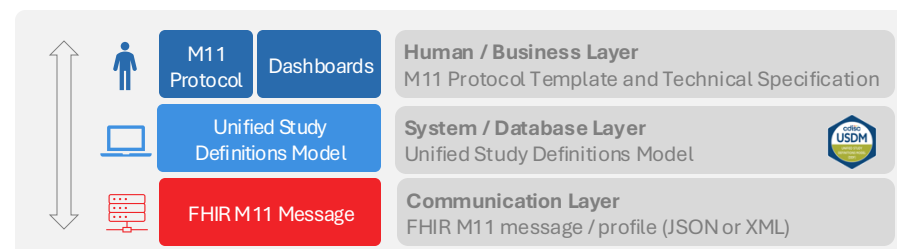
1

- M11 'docx' → USDM → FHIR
- Try and make it easy, "a few clicks"

FDA

2

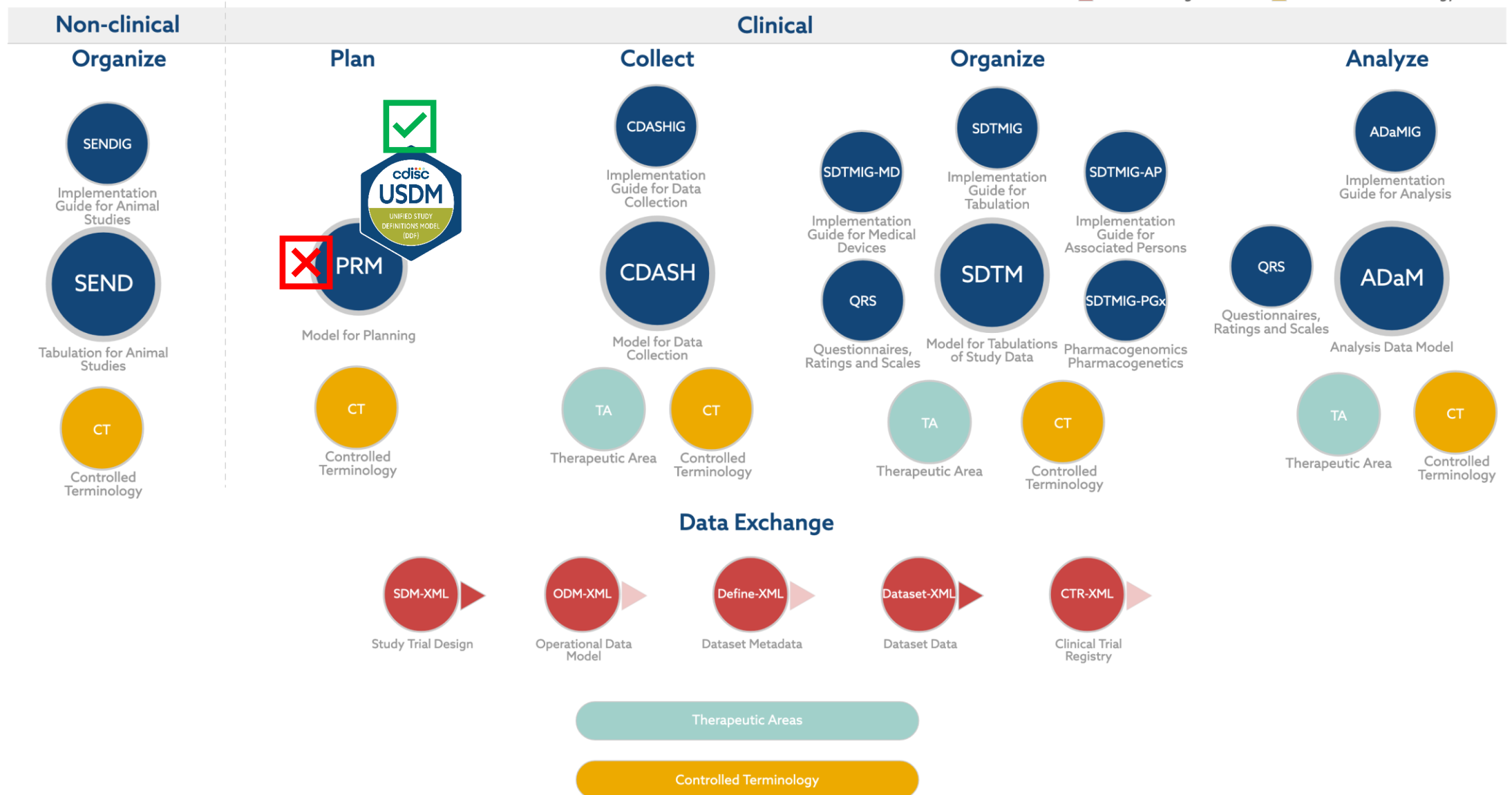
- FHIR → USDM → M11 Presentation
- Dashboards, what is possible?



How do the Pieces Fit?

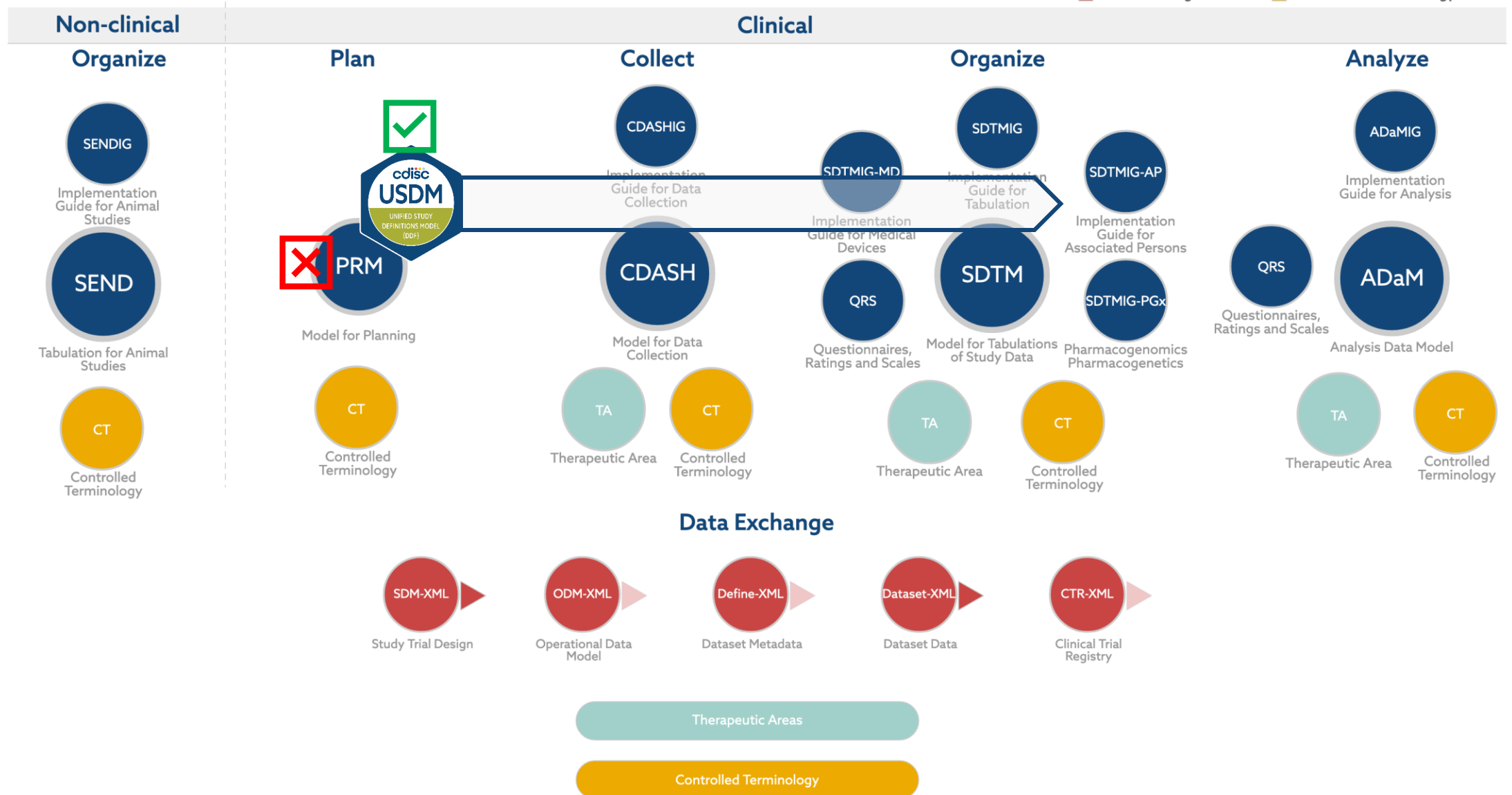
CDISC Standards in the Clinical Research Process

■ Foundational Standard ■ Therapeutic Area
■ Data Exchange ■ Controlled Terminology



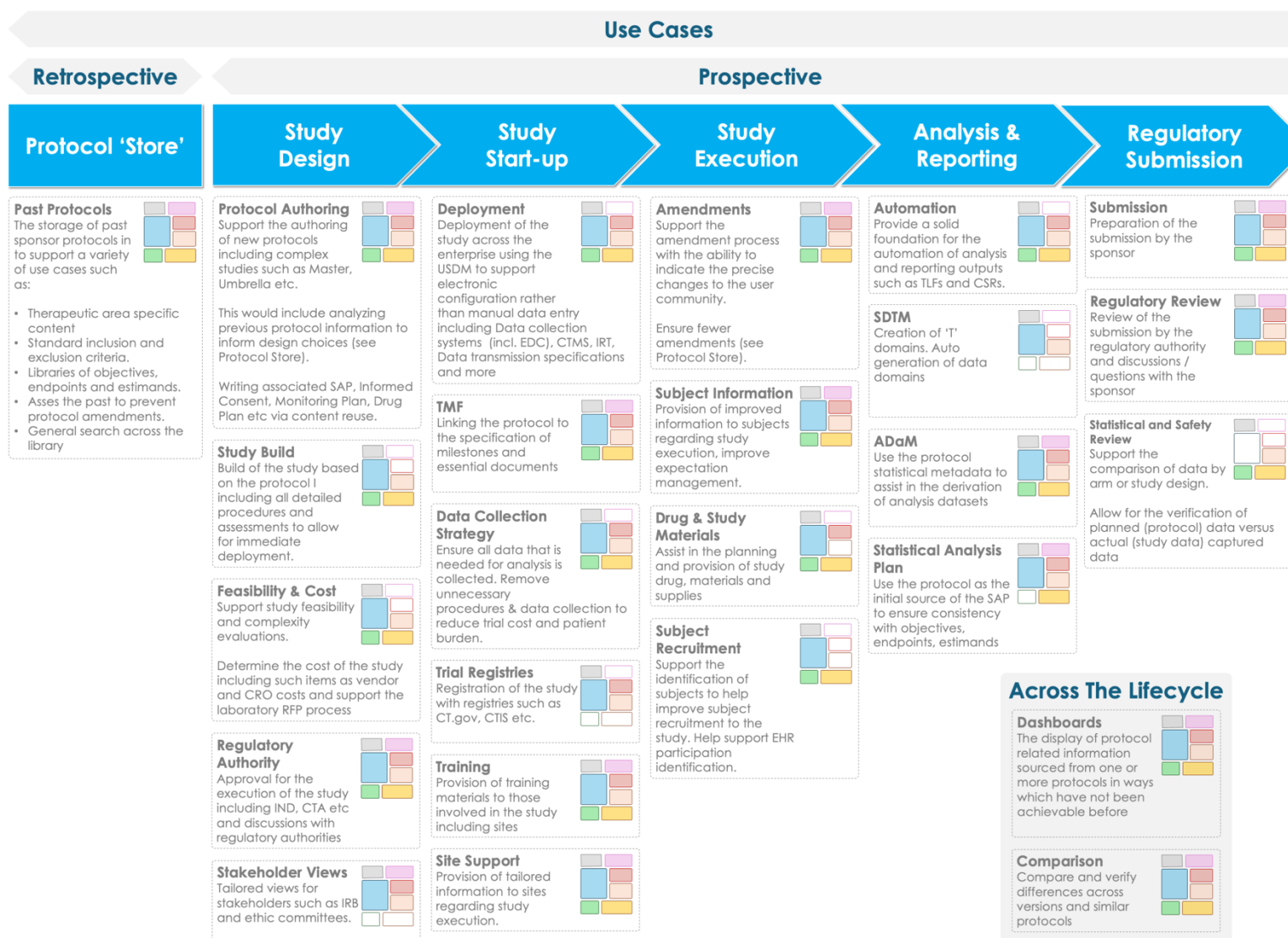
CDISC Standards in the Clinical Research Process

■ Foundational Standard ■ Therapeutic Area
■ Data Exchange ■ Controlled Terminology

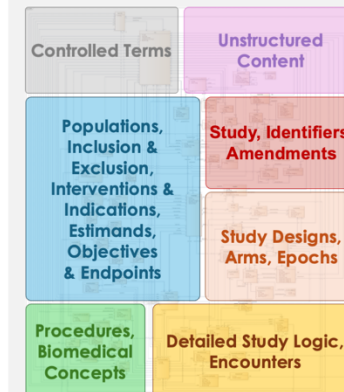


USDM in Action

Use Cases Supporting the DDF Vision



Unified Study Definitions Model (USDM)



Study Details
The overall study, its various versions, identifiers and associated governance. Also includes the amendments made to the study

Study High Level Design
The single or set of study designs making up the study detailing the epochs, arms etc.

Study Science
The detailed description of the study science: the populations and the associated inclusion and exclusion criteria, the indications being studied, the interventions being used and the objectives, endpoints and the associated estimands.

Detailed Study Logic
A precise definition of the study logic including support for the Schedule of Activities.

Unstructured Content
The ability to support one or more document presentations of the USDM content including the ICH M11 protocol template, sponsor templates and other documents.

Procedures and Biomedical Concepts
The detail around the procedures and observations to be performed as part of the detailed study designs.

Controlled Terms
The controlled terminology needed to define the semantics within the model. Managed in the same manner as all CDISC CT and aligned with the M11 template standard.

NOTE: The use cases presented are illustrative and the list is not intended to be exhaustive.

Use Cases



Scan Me

BCs Downstream?

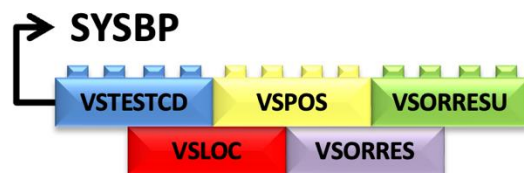
Sometime ago ...

DIA Annual, 2009

Looking at the meta data ...



USUBJID	VSSEQ	VSTESTCD	VSTEST	VSPOS	VSLOC	VSORRES	VSORRESU
ABC-001-001	12	SYSBP	Systolic Blood Pressure	SITTING	LEFT ARM	95	mmHg
ABC-001-001	13	DIABP	Diastolic Blood Pressure	SITTING	LEFT ARM	44	mmHg



In the same way as with lego we can plug the bricks together, so systolic blood pressure can be described by a collection of meta data bricks

Metadata ...

FDA's STUDY DATA TECHNICAL CONFORMANCE GUIDE

Contains Nonbinding Recommendations

Appendix: Data Standards and Interoperable Data Exchange

This appendix provides some of the guiding principles for the Agency's long-term study data standards management strategies. An important goal of standardizing study data submissions is to achieve an acceptable degree of *semantic interoperability* (discussed below). This appendix describes different types of interoperability and how data standards can support interoperable data exchange now and in the future.

At the most fundamental level, study data can be considered a collection of data elements and their relationships. A data element is the smallest (or *atomic*) piece of information that is useful for analysis (e.g., a systolic blood pressure measurement, a lab test result, a response to a question on a questionnaire).

A data value is by itself meaningless without additional information about the data (so called *metadata*). Metadata is often described as *data about data*. Metadata is structured information that describes, explains, or otherwise makes it easier to retrieve, use, or manage data.⁴⁸ For example, the number 44 itself is meaningless without an association with Hematocrit and the unit of measurement (e.g. "%"). Hematocrit in this example is metadata that further describes the data.

Just as it is important to standardize the representation of data (e.g., M and F for male and female, respectively), it is equally important to standardize the metadata. The

Contains Nonbinding Recommendations



Appendix A: Data Standards and Interoperable Data Exchange

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Just as it is important to standardize the representation of data (e.g., M and F for male and female, respectively), it is equally important to standardize the metadata. The expressions Hematocrit = 44; Hct = 44, or Hct Lab Test = 44 all convey the same information to a human, but an information system or analysis program will fail to recognize that they are equivalent because the metadata is not standardized. It is also important to standardize the

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frequently used to refer to XML (extensible markup language) tags, there is nothing new about the concept of metadata. Data about a library book such as author, type of book, and the Library of Congress number, are metadata and were once maintained on index cards. SAS labels and formats are a rudimentary form of metadata, although they have not historically been referred to as metadata.

Metadata is said to "give meaning to data" or to put data "in context." Although the term is now frequently used to refer to XML (extensible markup language) tags, there is nothing new about the concept of metadata. Data about a library book such as author, type of book, and the Library of Congress number, are metadata and were once maintained on index cards. SAS labels and formats are a rudimentary form of metadata, although they have not historically been referred to as metadata.

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Silver Spring, MD 20903
www.fda.gov

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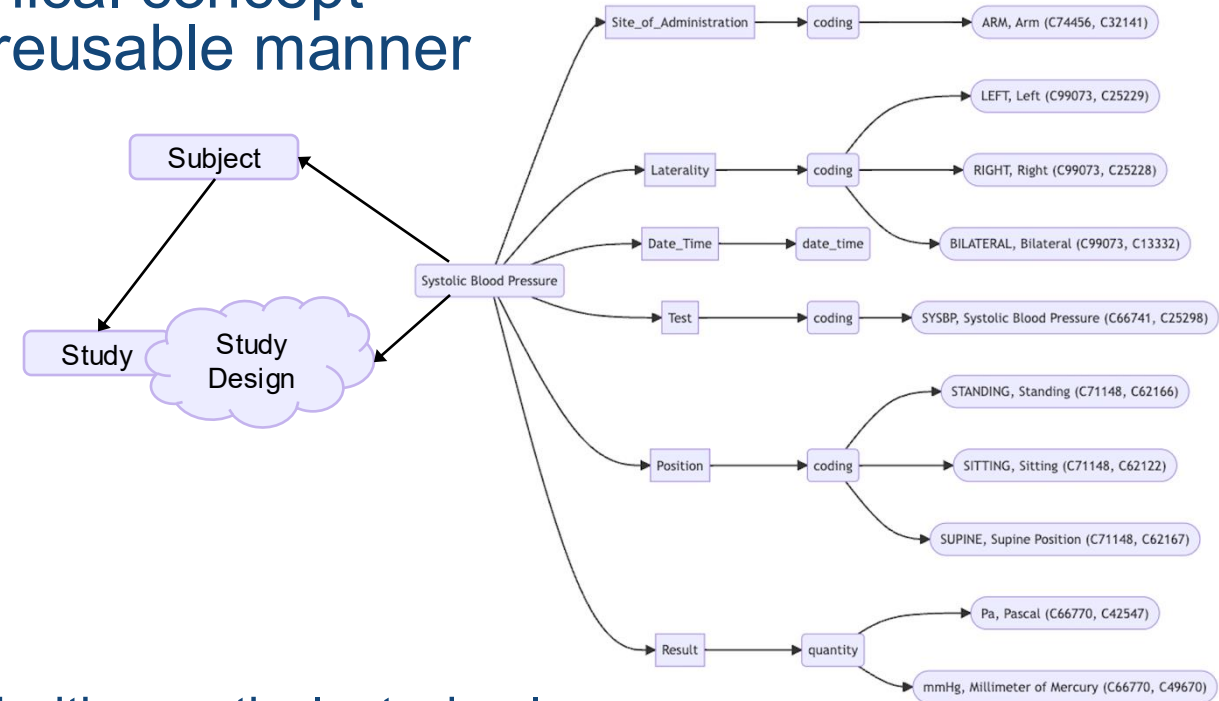
December, 2014

31

March, 2025

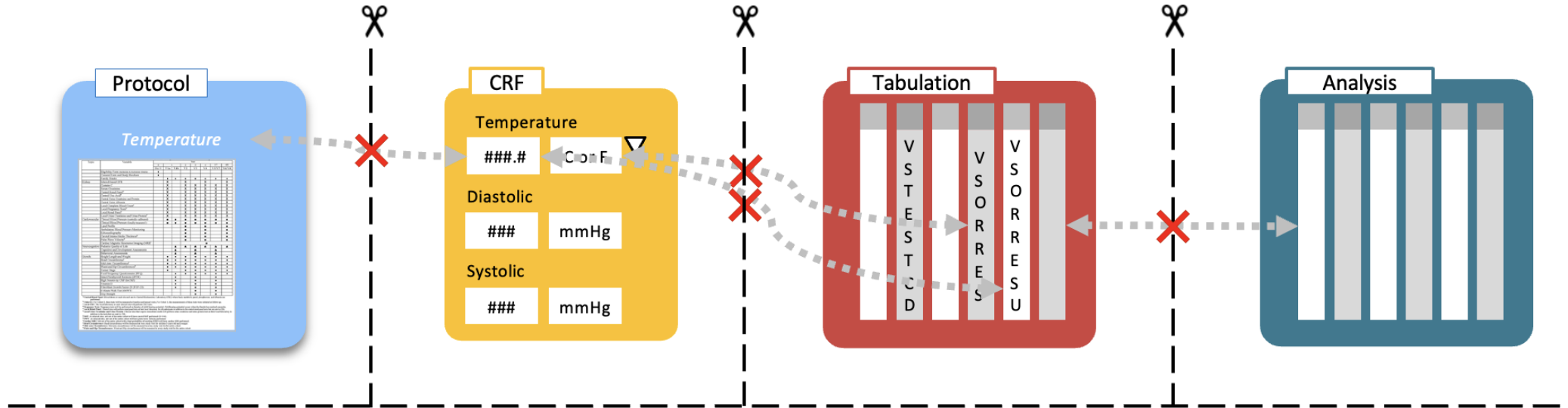
A Biomedical Concept is ...

- A small data model that defines a clinical concept (observation) in a standardized and reusable manner
- Atomic:
 - If it is split, it loses meaning
- Identifiable:
 - Has a unique identifier
 - Find it, reference it, deploy it
- Complete:
 - Everything is defined
- Data Specification
 - Specification of the data, not how it is used with a particular technology
- Context:
 - A BC needs context, i.e. the rest of the DDF model, a study, the encounters, activities, timing ...



Why BCs ... Silo Killers

PHUSE, 2019



Complexity

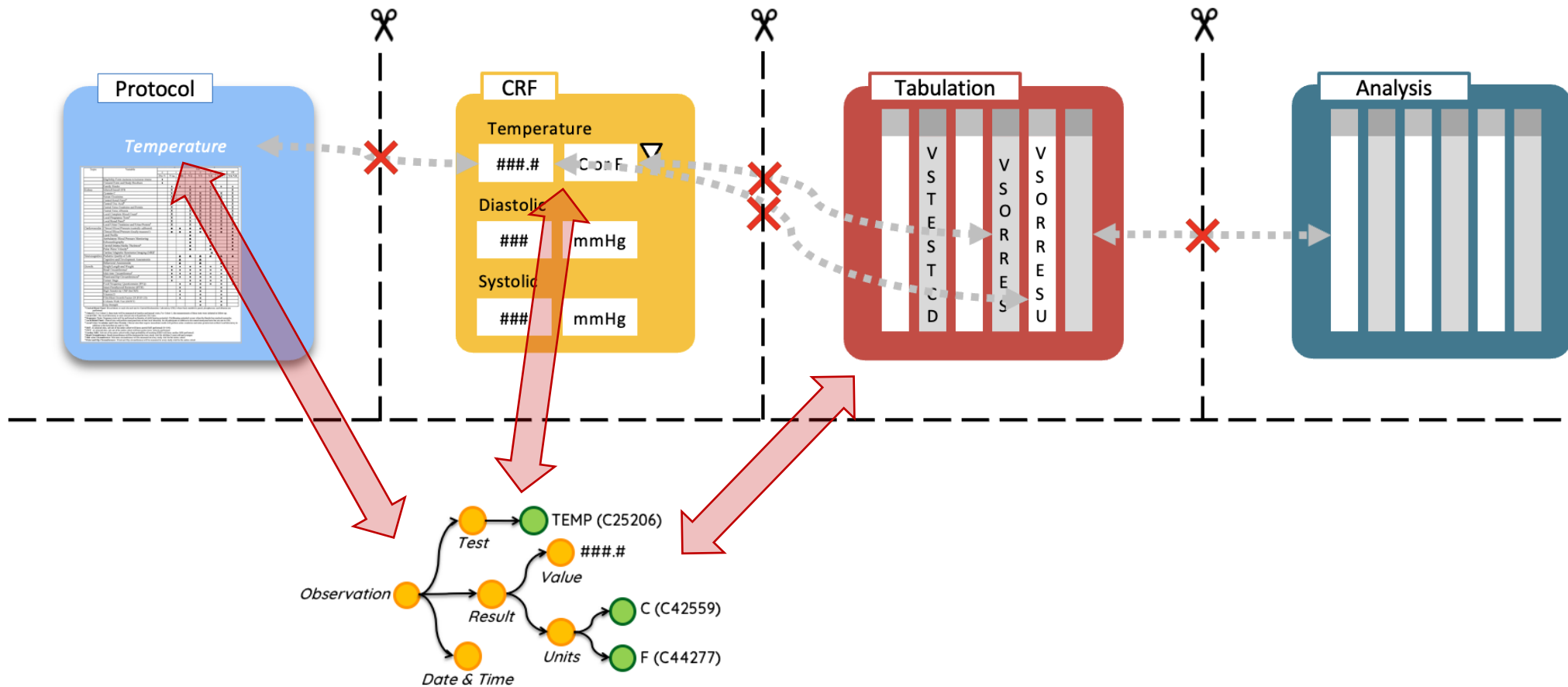
When standards were originally developed the space is so complex we split it up into manageable pieces ... But we created silos

CDISC standards are what we want, as humans, to see.

Why BCs ... Silo Killers

Machine / Data Layer

We need to remove the silos inside of the machine, give the machine more information, more context. We need to think about it from a machine / data perspective.

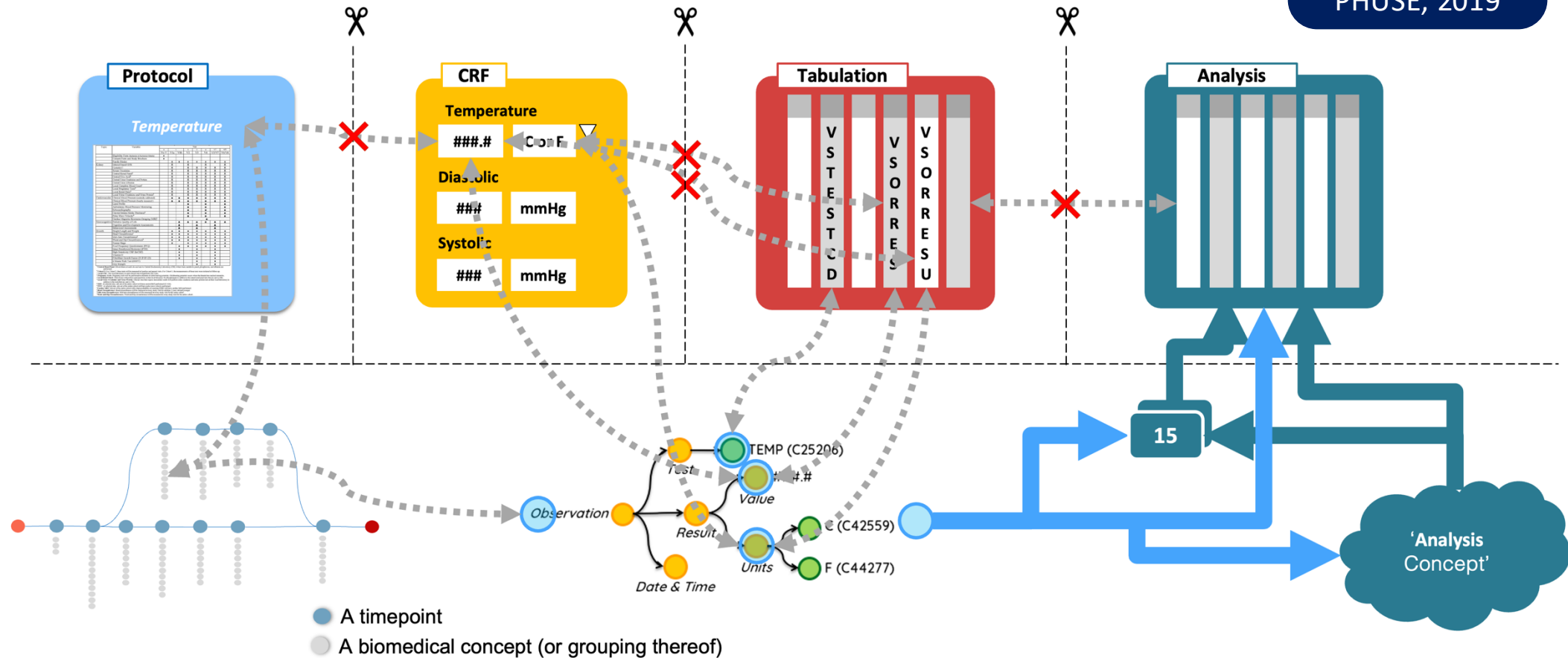


Machine / Data Layer

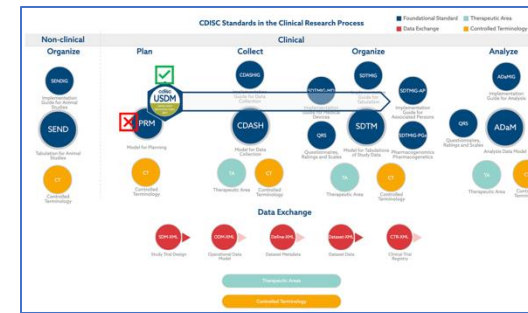
Machine / Data Layer

We need to remove the silos inside of the machine, give the machine more information, more context, put data at the centre.

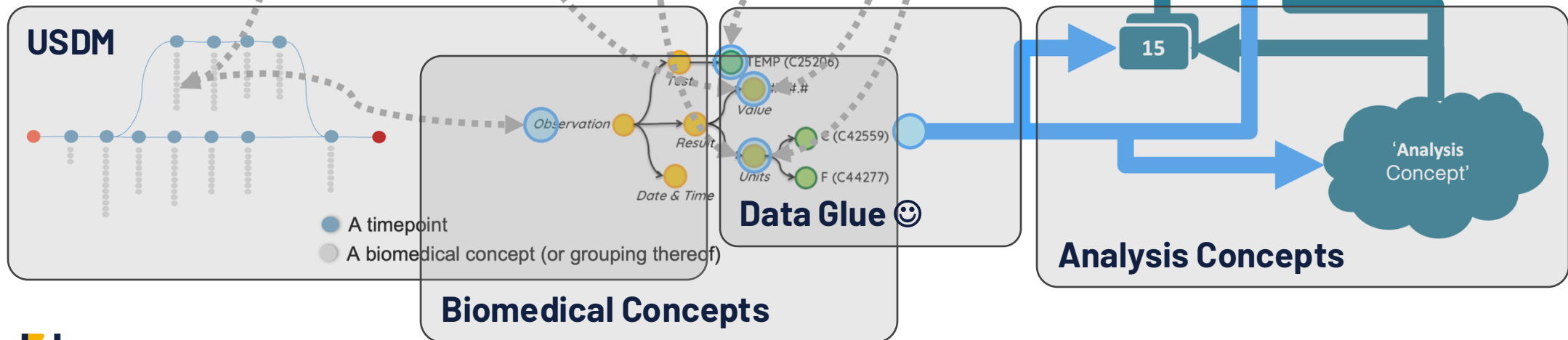
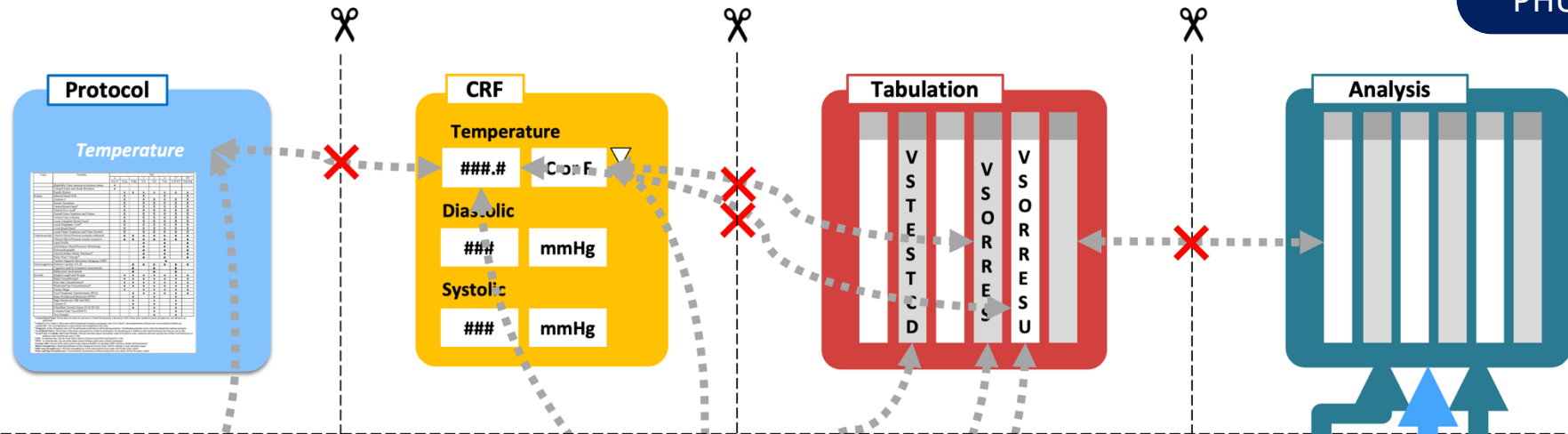
PHUSE, 2019



Machine / Data / Model Layer



PHUSE, 2019



Typical Protocol

Typical Protocol

SoA provides the activities and then references “labels” in footnotes and/or text detailing the observations required and various conditions.

Those “labels” are the names of BCs

USDM can provides that raft of information in a structured manner

Appendix 2
Schedule of Activities: Days 3–28

	Days 3–28 ^a																												Study Completion/ Discontinuation
Study Day	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28			
Chest X-ray/CT scan					x							x							x							x	x		
Vital signs ^b	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
PAO ₂ /FIO ₂ ^c	← Optional →																												Optional
SpO ₂ ^d	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Ordinal scoring ^d	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Adverse events ^e	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Concomitant medications ^f	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Hematology ^g	x				x			x				x							x							x	x		
Chemistry ^h	x				x			x				x							x							x	x		
Central Labs																													
Serum PD (CRP, IL-6, sIL-6R)	x				x							x							x							x	x		
Serum PK					x							x							x							x	x		
Serum sample for exploratory biomarkers	x				x							x							x							x	x		
SARS-CoV-2 viral load ⁱ	x	x	x	x	x			x				x							x							x	x		
Serum SARS-CoV-2 antibody titer																										x	x		
Cryopreserved PBMCs ^j	x				x							x							x							x	x		

4.5.4

Vital Signs and Oxygen Saturation

Vital signs will include measurements of respiratory rate, pulse rate, and systolic and diastolic blood pressures, and body temperature. Peripheral oxygen saturation should also be measured at the same time as the vitals. For patients requiring supplemental oxygen, the oxygen flow rate (L/min) and/or fraction of inspired oxygen (FiO₂) should be recorded.

^b All vital sign measurements (i.e., respiratory rate, pulse rate, systolic and diastolic blood pressures, and body temperature), oxygen saturation and NEWS2-specific assessments (i.e., consciousness and presence or absence of oxygen support) should be recorded together twice daily with approximately 12 hours in between while the patient remains hospitalized. If measured more than once during a 12-hour period, the worst values (highest temperature, respiratory rate, and heart rate, lowest blood pressure, oxygen saturation, and consciousness level) during that period should be recorded on the eCRF. Following hospital discharge these parameters should be recorded once at each return visit to the clinic. Vital signs and oxygen saturation will not be recorded if follow-up visits are conducted by telephone.

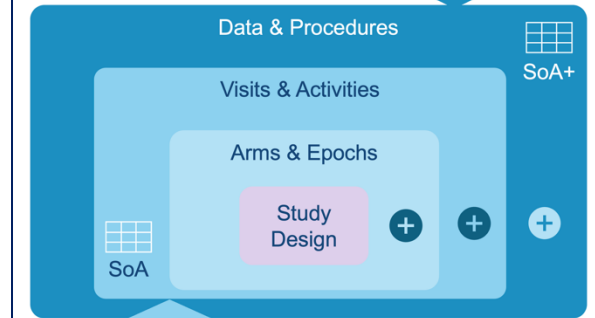
USDM & SoA+

SoA and SoA+

SoA is the information we typically see in the SoA table in a paper protocol. SoA+ is the extra detail defining the observations. SoA+ is the linking in of the BCs to provide the information found in the footnotes etc.

Increasing Detail

Provide precision on the data to be captured to the capture systems in a generic manner to facilitate automation. The data precision has not, typically, been in the "paper" protocol. It is SoA "plus", SoA+

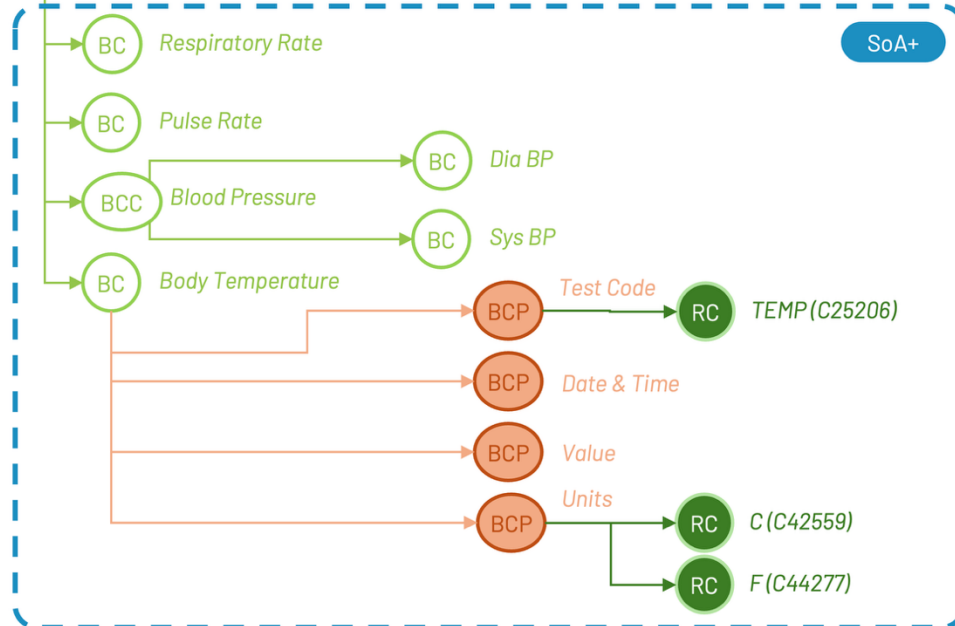
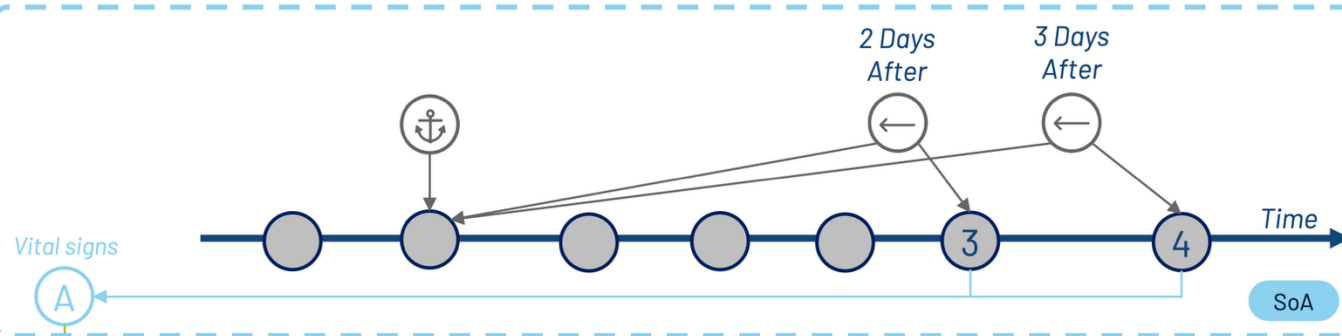


Current "Limit"

SoA is where we are today with associated footnotes and free text. Activities sit at a CRF form "level"

Technology Independent

Definition should be independent of any capture technology



Appendix 2 Schedule of Activities: Days 3–28

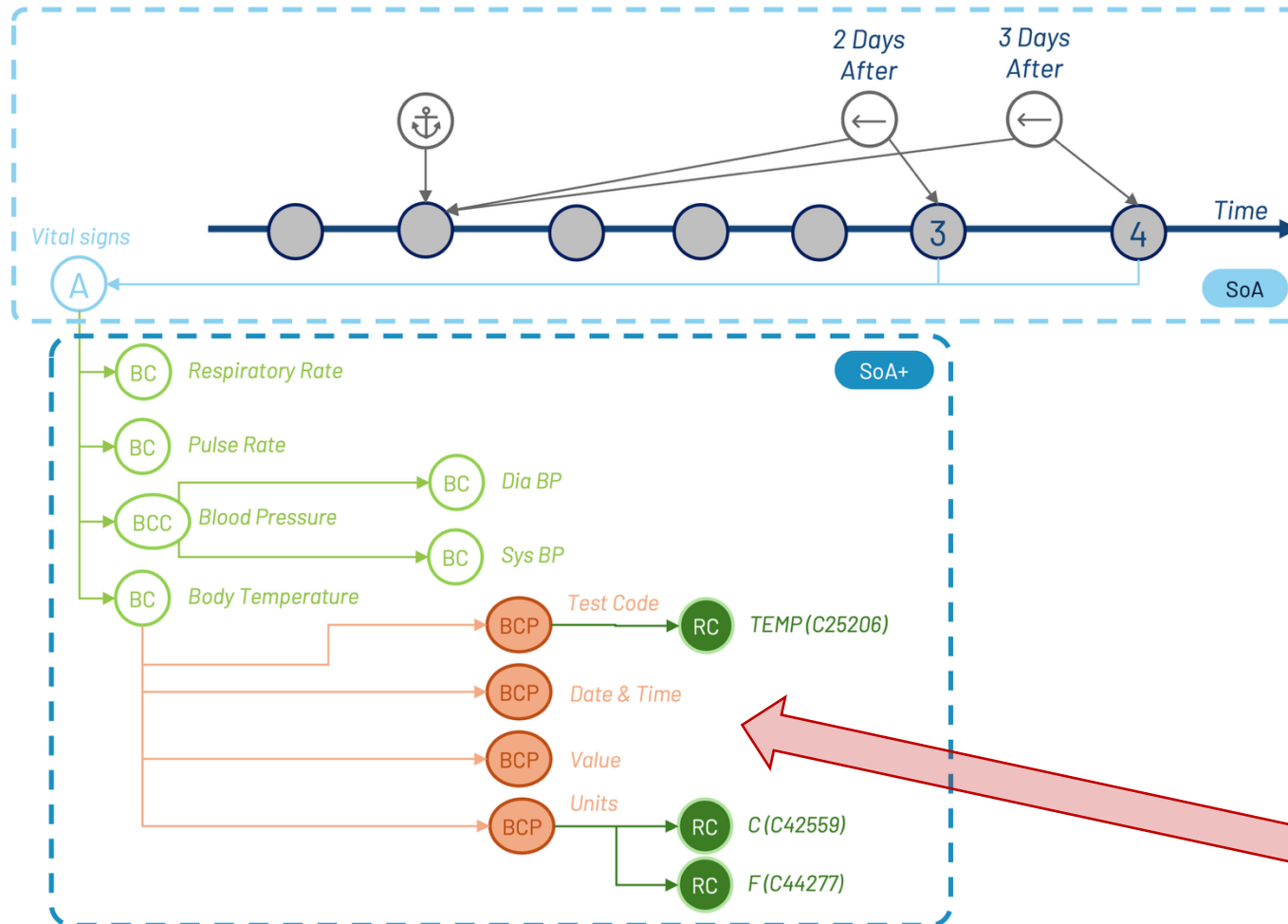
	Days 3–28 ^a																												Study Completion/ Discontinuation
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Chest X-ray/CT scan					x							x							x							x	x		
Vital signs ^b	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
PaO ₂ /FIO ₂ ^c	← Optional →																												Optional
SpO ₂ ^b	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Ordinal scoring ^d	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Adverse events ^e	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Concomitant medications ^f	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
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Serum PK					x							x							x						x		x		
Serum sample for exploratory biomarkers	x				x							x							x						x		x		
SARS-CoV-2 viral load ⁱ	x	x	x	x	x				x			x							x						x		x		
Serum SARS-CoV-2 antibody titer																									x		x		
Cryopreserved PBMCs ^j	x				x							x							x						x		x		

1. Link to Existing CRF Library



“Traditional” Approach (Walk)

Take the BCs in the design and “map” to an existing forms library and work in a traditional manner for the remainder of the left-cycle as per today (e.g. SDTM).



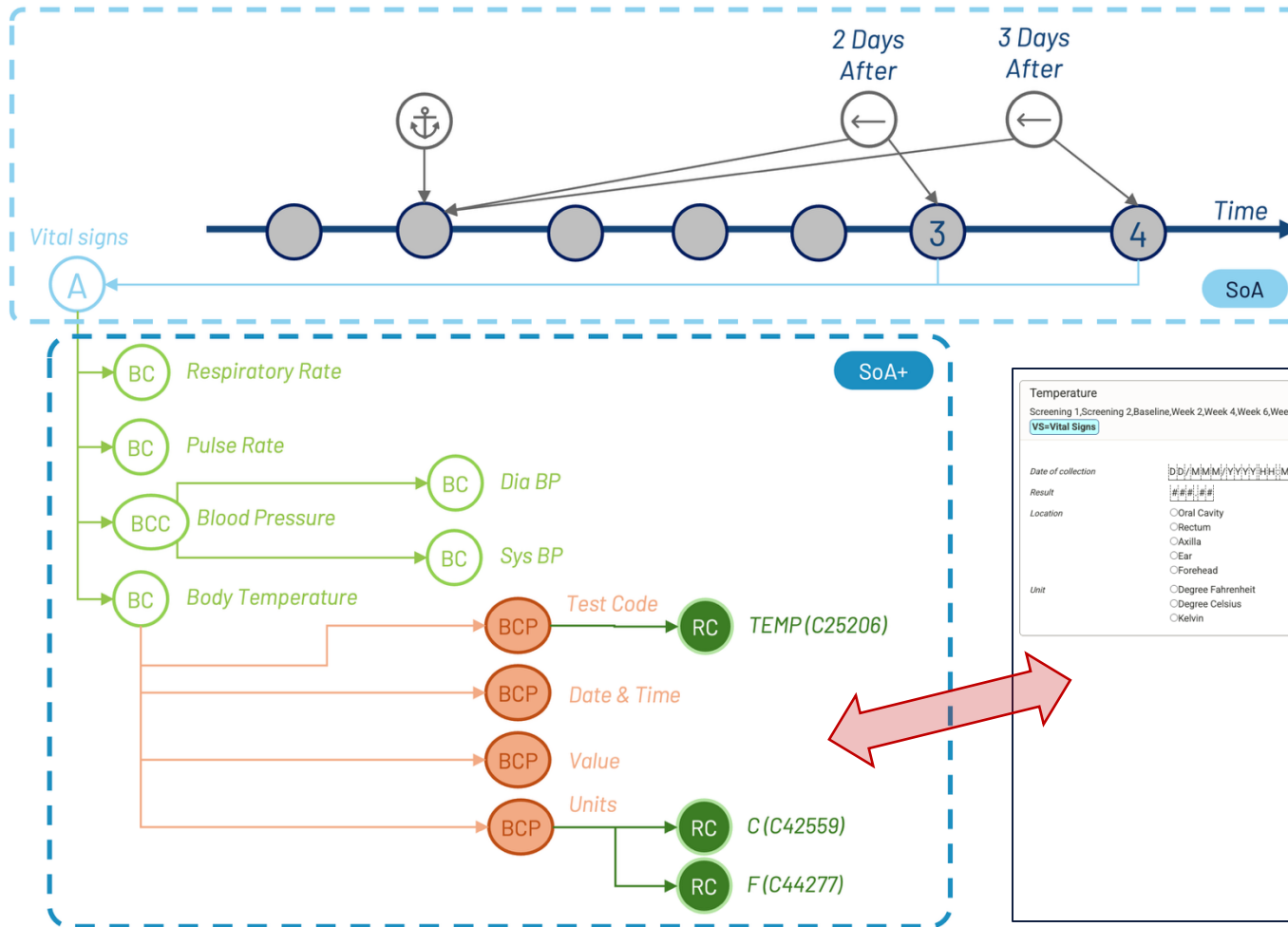
Form VS - Vital Signs HorizontalGeneric	
VS - Horizontal Header	
Were vital signs performed?	☐ No ☐ Yes
What was the date of the measurement(s)?	Set Date 01 Jan 2000
VS - Implementation Options: HorizontalGeneric	
What was the result of the Systolic Blood Pressure measurement?	
* What was the unit of the Systolic Blood Pressure measurement?	mmHg
What was the result of the Diastolic Blood Pressure measurement?	
* What was the unit of the Diastolic Blood Pressure measurement?	mmHg
What was the position of the subject during the blood pressure measurement?	Choose
What was the anatomical location where the blood pressure measurement was taken?	Choose
What was the result of the height measurement?	
What was the unit of the height measurement?	☐ Centimeter ☐ Inch
What was the result of the weight measurement?	
What was the unit of the weight measurement?	☐ Kilogram ☐ Pound
What was the result of the pulse measurement?	
* What was the unit of the pulse measurement?	beats/min
* What was the anatomical location where the pulse measurement was taken?	Choose
What was the result of the respiratory rate measurement?	
* What was the unit of the Respiratory Rate Unit measurement?	breaths/min
What was the result of the temperature measurement?	
What was the unit of the Temperature Unit measurement?	☐ Celsius ☐ Fahrenheit
What was the anatomical location where the temperature was taken?	Choose

2. Generate Forms



More Adventurous Approach (Jog)

Take the BCs in the design and dynamically generate forms etc. Work in a traditional manner for the remainder of the left-cycle as per today (e.g. SDTM).



Temperature

Screening 1, Screening 2, Baseline, Week 2, Week 4, Week 6, Week 8, Week 12, Week 16, Week 20, Week 24, Week 26

VS=Vital Signs

Date of collection DD/MM/YYYY HH:MM

Result ##.##

Location

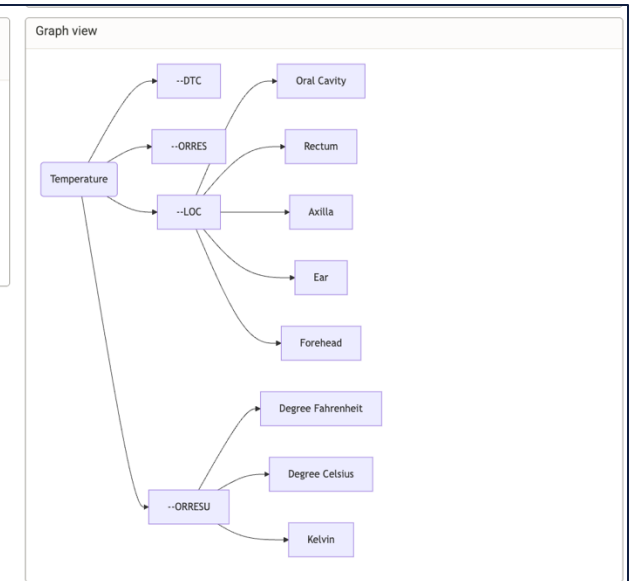
Unit

VSDTC

VSORRES

VSLOC

VSORRESU



Use the USDM as the start of an operation model (extend the USDM) to bring design and data together. Generate the forms and link to the study definition. This also allows for auto creation of define.xml, aCRF, SDTM via linking in other models (not shown on this slide).



The background is a dark blue gradient with various geometric shapes and lines. On the left, there is a network of small circles connected by thin lines. In the center and right, there are larger, glowing yellow circles and lines, some of which are connected to a bright yellow circular glow at the bottom right. There are also several small, semi-transparent cubes scattered throughout the scene.

Benefits?

Benefits

Single Source of Truth

USDM's standardized framework eliminates data silos that have plagued clinical research by providing robust APIs for seamless data exchange across diverse platforms.

This ensures study data is consistently and reliable.

Reduce Cycle-Time

USDM can help reduce cycle times across the clinical trial lifecycle through the use of automation.

Given the large number of activities within each study, saving just a few hours on each activity quickly accumulates to substantial time savings across the entire clinical trial process.

This enables organizations to increase their clinical trial capacity.

Automation

USDM & BCs enable systems like EDC, CTMS, RTSM etc to be automatically configured from a single, standardized study definition.

This eliminates the need for manual transcription from PDF protocols into multiple systems, significantly reducing human error and accelerating study startup times through the "write once, read many times" principle.

Regulatory Compliance

A shared data model fosters better communication and alignment not only with among sponsors, CROs, and vendors but also with regulators.

The combination of USDM & ICH M11 will facilitate dialogue with regulators across the globe.

AI Enhancement Through Context

USDM & BCs serve as a catalyst for AI technologies by providing data with the full trial design context.

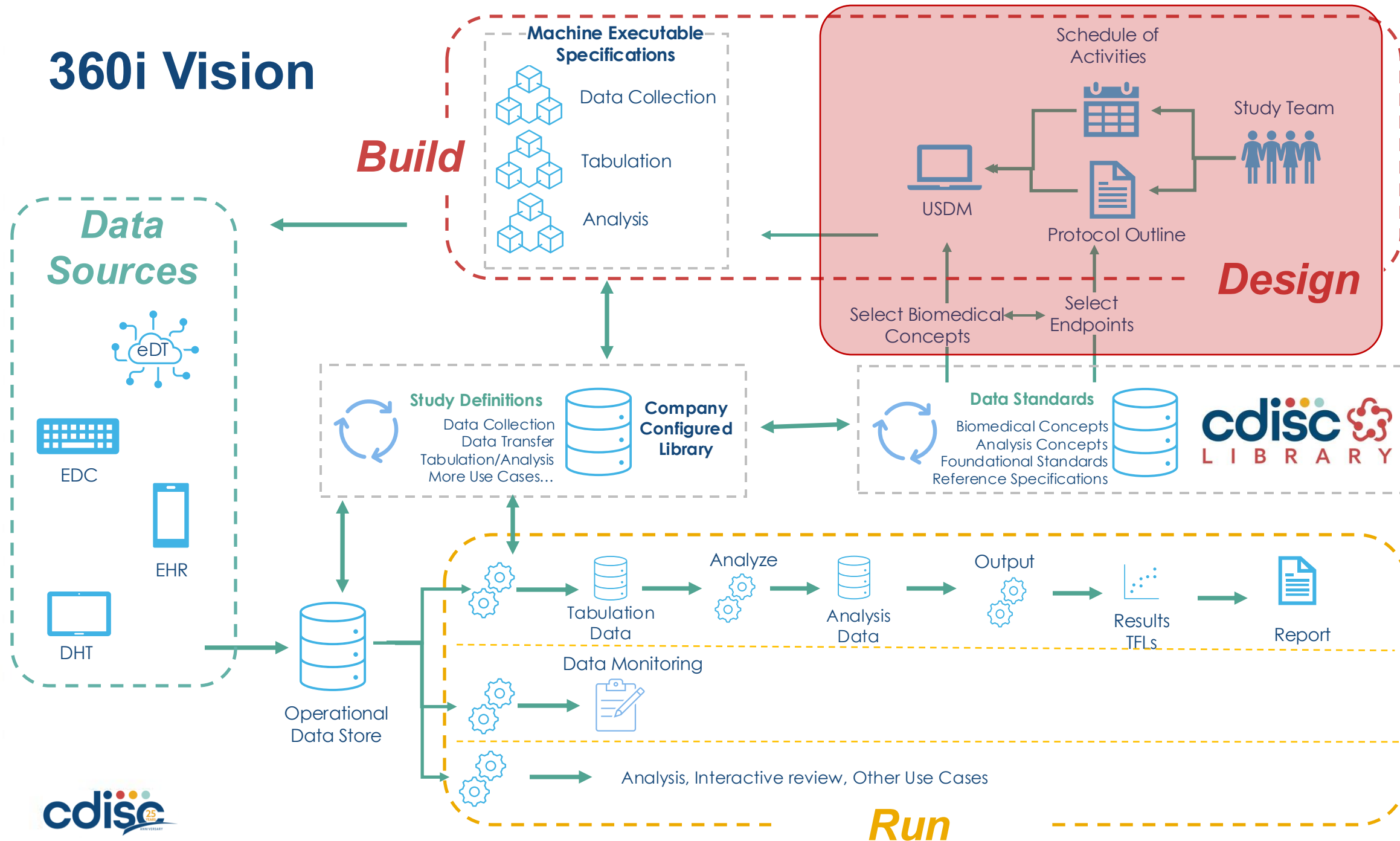
These study definitions, improved data quality, and enhanced cross-study consistency.

It addresses the critical limitation that "AI doesn't solve our context problems; it amplifies them" by bringing essential context to clinical trial data, empowering AI to operate more effectively.

The background is a dark blue gradient with various geometric shapes and lines. There are several yellow circles of different sizes, some connected by thin yellow lines. There are also grey cubes and spheres scattered throughout. A bright yellow circular glow is at the bottom right, with lines radiating from it. The overall theme is futuristic and technological.

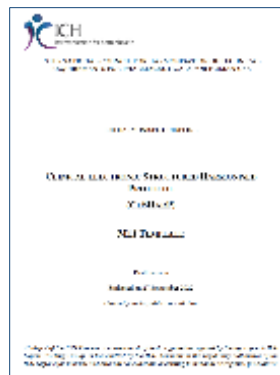
What's Next?

360i Vision



USDM Phase 5

ICH & M11 Specifications
Align when final public version released



USDM Phase 5
Stability. The foundation for CDISC 360i. Scoping ongoing.

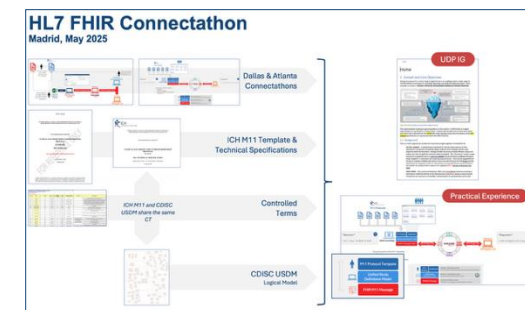


precisionFDA Regulatory Information Service Module
FDA-Industry Research Collaboration Agreement
(Public-Private Partnership)

FDA & PRISM
Working with FDA to pilot first electronic transfer of an M11 protocol as well as tooling to support



HL7 Vulcan & UDP
Working with HL7 Vulcan to build FHIR message to support exchange of USDM / M11 content.



EMA, M11 & CTIS
Working with EMA to align USDM with CTIS



TransCelerate & Adoption
Sponsor and vendors working with USDM. Latest adoption will be visible at the TransCelerate 'Mission Possible' days in September



Summary

- The electronic protocol (USDM v4) is with us now
- USDM is consistent and aligned with the ICH M11 Template
- USDM offers several routes to automation and efficiency gains
- Biomedical Concepts are key to achieving the full benefits

